

The 15-Minute Google Lead Leak Audit for Service Businesses: Find Exactly Where You're Losing Booked Jobs

In 15 minutes, score the 5 places your Google setup quietly leaks leads and walk away with a ranked list of what to fix first.

How to run this audit (read this first)

This is a diagnosis, not a lecture. You are going to check 5 specific places where service businesses lose Google leads they already paid to attract, score each one from 0 to 4, and total the result at the end. The whole thing takes about 15 minutes.

You will need three things open in browser tabs: your Google Business Profile (search your business name while logged into the owner account, or go to business.google.com), your Google Ads account if you run ads (ads.google.com), and your phone with your call history. If you do not run Google Ads, score Section 3 as 0 and note it, because that is itself a finding we will come back to.

Score honestly. The point is not a good number, it is a true number. Each section tells you exactly what a 4 looks like, what a 0 looks like, and the tool or report to check so you are not guessing. Write your section scores in the margin as you go. A perfect audit is 20. Most service businesses I audit land between 6 and 11 on the first pass, which means roughly half of their potential booked jobs are leaking out before anyone ever speaks to a human.

Check 1: Your Google Business Profile (the free leads you ignore)

Your Business Profile is the map pack listing that shows up before the ads and before the website links. For local service businesses it is often the single biggest source of calls, and it is free. It is also where the most obvious leaks hide.

Check these four items and give yourself 1 point for each that passes:

1. Primary category is your money service, not a vague one. A '24/7 emergency plumber' should have the primary category 'Emergency plumber service', not just 'Plumber'. Open your profile, click Edit profile, and read the primary category out loud. If it is broader than the exact job you want to be called for, you fail this point.
2. You have 25 or more photos and at least one added in the last 30 days. Profiles with fresh photos get more profile views. Check the Photos tab and sort by date. Stale or fewer than 25 photos fails.
3. Review velocity: at least 1 new review in the last 30 days, and every review from the last 90 days has a reply. Open the Reviews tab. No recent reviews, or unanswered ones, fails. Replying signals an active business to both Google and the customer reading them.
4. Your phone number on the profile is a number you actually answer during business hours, and the 'Call' button has generated calls in the last 30 days (check Performance, then Calls). If you cannot see

any calls, either the number is wrong or tracking is off. Either way, fail it.

Section 1 score (0 to 4): _____. A 0 to 2 here is the most common and most expensive leak I find, because these are calls from people ready to book today.

Check 2: Wasted ad spend (the search terms report nobody opens)

If you run Google Ads, this is where money leaves the building. The trap is that the keywords you chose are not the same as the search terms people actually typed to trigger your ad. Broad and phrase match keywords fire your ad on searches you never intended, and you pay for every click.

Do this: in Google Ads, go to a campaign, click 'Insights and reports', then 'Search terms'. Set the date range to the last 30 days. Now look at the actual phrases. You are hunting for clicks you paid for that could never become a job: searches with 'free', 'DIY', 'jobs', 'salary', 'how to', 'near me' for a town you do not serve, or a competitor's name.

Score it: - 4 points: less than 5% of spend went to irrelevant terms, and you have a negative keyword list with 20 or more entries. - 2 points: 5% to 20% wasted, or a thin negative list under 20 entries. - 0 points: more than 20% of spend on irrelevant terms, or you have never opened this report, or you have no negative keyword list at all.

Add the irrelevant terms up. If you spend 2,000 dollars a month and 20% is waste, that is 400 dollars a month, 4,800 dollars a year, going to clicks that were never going to call you. Write your wasted dollar figure here: _____. Section 2 score (0 to 4): _____.

Check 3: Is your conversion tracking even firing?

This is the leak that makes every other decision blind. If Google does not know which clicks turn into calls and form fills, it cannot optimize toward your real customers, and you cannot know which campaigns make money. I find broken or missing tracking in roughly 4 out of 10 accounts I audit.

Run this 3-minute test:

1. In Google Ads, go to Goals, then Conversions, then Summary. Look at the 'Status' column for your primary conversion actions (calls, form submissions, booking requests). Anything that says 'No recent conversions' or 'Tag inactive' is a red flag.
2. Install the free Chrome extension 'Google Tag Assistant' (or use Tag Assistant at tagassistant.google.com). Load your website, then submit your contact form with a test entry or click your tracked phone number. Watch whether a conversion tag actually fires. If nothing fires, you are flying blind.
3. Check that phone calls from ads are tracked, not just form fills. Service businesses get most leads by phone. If only form submissions are counted, you are invisible to your own data.

Score it: - 4 points: calls and forms both tracked, tags firing, conversions recorded in the last 7 days. - 2 points: only one of calls or forms tracked, or conversions exist but you are unsure they are accurate. - 0 points: no conversion tracking, tags not firing, or status shows inactive.

Section 3 score (0 to 4): _____. If you scored 0 here, treat it as the first thing to fix. Everything downstream depends on it.

Check 4: Speed to lead (the 5-minute window you are missing)

A lead is only worth something if you reach them while they are still deciding. The data on this is brutal and consistent: contacting a web lead within 5 minutes versus 30 minutes makes you far more likely to actually connect and qualify them, and most leads go with whoever responds first. For service businesses, the leak is missed calls and form fills that sit unanswered for hours.

Measure your reality, not your intention:

1. Missed calls: look at your phone's call history for the last 7 business days. Count how many incoming calls during business hours went unanswered and were never called back within 10 minutes. Each missed, un-retuned call from a Google source is a leaked job.

2. Form response time: find the last 5 contact form or booking submissions. Check the timestamp of the lead versus the timestamp of your first reply (email or call). Calculate the average gap in minutes.

Score it: - 4 points: under 5% of business-hour calls missed and un-retuned, and average form reply under 5 minutes. - 2 points: occasional missed calls, or average form reply between 5 and 60 minutes. - 0 points: regular missed calls with no callback system, or form replies taking longer than 1 hour (or you are not sure, which usually means too long).

Section 4 score (0 to 4): _____. This leak feels operational, not marketing, but it determines whether the leads from Checks 1 to 3 ever become revenue. The fastest fix is a missed-call-to-text autoresponder and a rule that every form fill gets a call attempt within 5 minutes.

Check 5: Where the click lands (the page that has to close the lead)

You can win every check above and still leak the lead on the page they land on. The job of that page is one thing: get a ready buyer to call or submit. Most service business pages bury the phone number and ask the visitor to think too hard.

Load the exact page your ads or profile send people to, on your phone, not your desktop. Now score 1 point for each that passes:

1. Your phone number is visible without scrolling, and on mobile it is tap-to-call (a real tel: link, not just text). If you have to scroll to find how to contact you, fail.

2. The page loads in under 3 seconds on mobile. Test it free at PageSpeed Insights (pagespeed.web.dev). A mobile performance score under 50, or a load over 3 seconds, fails. Every extra second of load loses a share of visitors before they see anything.

3. The headline names the exact service and area, matching what they searched. Someone who searched 'emergency AC repair Austin' should see those words, not 'Welcome to our website'. A generic headline fails.

4. There is one clear next action above the fold (call now, or a short form of 3 fields or fewer). Multiple competing buttons, or a long form, fails. Every extra form field costs you completions.

Section 5 score (0 to 4): _____. A high-traffic page that fails here is the most frustrating leak of all, because you already paid to get them there.

Your score, and the one thing to do next

Add up your five section scores. Total out of 20: _____.

16 to 20: Strong. Your leaks are minor and you are likely leaving only a small fraction of jobs on the table. Tighten your lowest section and move on.

11 to 15: Leaking. You have at least one or two checks costing you real, countable jobs every month. Fix your two lowest-scoring sections first, in order.

6 to 10: Major leaks. This is where most service businesses land. Roughly half of the booked jobs your Google presence could be producing are draining out before you ever talk to them. The good news is these are fixable, and the dollar figures you wrote down in Sections 2 and 4 show you exactly what they are worth.

0 to 5: You are paying for a faucet with no bucket under it. Stop adding traffic and fix tracking (Check 3) and speed to lead (Check 4) before anything else.

Here is the honest part. Finding the leaks is the easy half. Plugging them and keeping them plugged, every month, while you run your actual business, is the hard half, because Google changes, competitors bid against you, and an untended account drifts back to leaking within weeks.

That is the work Mark-eting does for service businesses month after month: we run these exact checks on your live account, attach a dollar value to each leak, fix them, and then manage your Google leads continuously so the calls and tracked form fills keep landing in your calendar.

If you want me to run this audit on your real numbers and show you what each leak is costing you, reply to my email with the single word LEADS. I will send back what a managed month looks like for a business your size. That is the whole next step.